

DOS would ask for a command using the *Command Prompt*, and you would type in what you wanted it to do. If you had lots of commands which you needed to run over and over again, you would use the handy 'batch' file—just type in all your commands into the batch file, save it, and now all you needed to do was to tell DOS to run this batch file, and it would run all your commands without disturbing you.

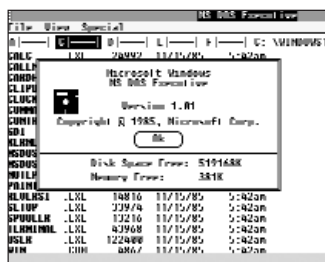
DOS has always been part of its successors, and Microsoft only ceased further development on it in the year 2000.

The forgotten uncle—Windows 1.0

Somewhere in 1983, Microsoft offered to rescue its users from the drab and tedious interface of DOS by introducing the first GUI (Graphical User Interface). Instead of having to type in their commands, users would be able to use the nifty new ‘mouse’ to point and click on what they wanted to do. What’s more, they’d be doing this in a brand new environment with pretty colours and everything. They first called it the ‘Interface Manager’, but then changed it to the more appealing ‘Windows’. Windows 1.0 launched in November 1985.

Windows 1.0 gave users the ability to run more than one DOS application at the same time. However, it isn't really regarded as a full-fledged operating system—rather, it was an extension to DOS that gave users a friendlier environment to run their applications, most of which were written for DOS. Many DOS applications still accessed hardware directly, rather than using the device drivers that Windows supplied. Files were managed using the MS-DOS Executive, which was a marginally better looking interface than the old DOS way.

The development of Windows' GUI was tough for Microsoft—they faced possible legal battles



The MSDOS Executive in Windows 1.0